



Intel's failures

Intel's plans to outsource chip production signals the end of an era for the semiconductor industry in the US. <https://digit.in/aug20-81>



Zoom hardware subscriptions

Zoom has indicated that it intends to introduce its hardware based subscription plans in India. <https://digit.in/aug20-82>

out after switching the printer off and wait for about 30-60 seconds before plugging it back in and using the 'Resume' button method. Then there is the accompanying software that printers have, you can use that to reset printers. The more recent touchscreen only printers have done away with most buttons so there's usually a menu item to perform a reset. The odd thing here is that if

the touchscreen is ever affected by a glitch, you will find it a bit difficult to perform the reset. However, there is always a fall-back mechanism.

So, my colleague started going through these steps one after the other and had to take a break for some coffee between these steps. When he did come back, the printer had magically reset. Turns out his daughter saw him messing with the

printer and decided to help out by pulling the power cable and she'd let enough time pass before plugging it back in. And that reset the printer back to factory settings. So, the ancient trick of 'switching it off and turning it back on again' actually did work in this case, all it needed was enough time for the power to completely dissipate from the internal circuits.

BUYING ADVICE

SMALL FORM FACTOR UPGRADE

Q Hi there, Agent 001!

I'm a 12-year-old Unity dev and I was thinking of upgrading my computer. My current rig is as follows –

- 6 GB DDR3 RAM (both chips with different clocks)
- Intel celeron G1610 @ 2.6 GHz clock speed
- Some local, weird motherboard I don't know about.
- 220V(?) PSU
- 500 GB SATA WD hard drive



GIGABYTE GA-A320M-S2H

I was thinking of upgrading to this –

- AMD Ryzen 3300X
 - GIGABYTE GA-A320M-S2H motherboard
 - 2 x Crucial 8GB DDR4 RAM 2400 Mhz
 - MSI GT 710 2GB Graphics card
- And also, my case's size is 33.5 x 17.5 x 33.5 cm.

I will use this computer for playing games (CS:GO and similar games)

at medium settings and mostly for game development using Unity. Can you suggest a better graphics card for this purpose in this price range (under ₹7K)? Also, which PSU will this rig need? Please help me out with this rig, Agent 001!

–Tejas “TheLoneWolf” Joshi

A Hey TheLoneWolf, You've actually picked a very good CPU and Motherboard combination, but since you mentioned that your case is 33.5 x 17.5 x 33.5, it might be a tight fit. Check if your existing motherboard dimensions are the same as Micro-ATX (24.4 x 19.5 cm), in which case, this board is sufficient. Also, the AMD Ryzen 3 3300X is a recent processor which is supported by the motherboard from BIOS version F40 onwards, so get that checked before you buy the board or you won't be able to start the PC till you upgrade the BIOS using Q-Flash. Q-Flash allows you to upgrade the BIOS without connecting the CPU or the memory.

Coming to the graphics card, you can certainly switch from the GT710 to a GT1030 to get way better performance and it'll still be under ₹7K. A card such as the ZOTAC GT1030 (ZT-P10300A-10L) which comes with an additional low-profile bracket might just be what you're looking for. Your total power consumption would be around 245 Watts so a power supply such as the Corsair CV450 should be more than sufficient for your needs. All PSUs in India are rated for 220V so

we're more concerned with the Wattage rather than the Voltage.

LAPTOP FOR ENGINEERING

Q Dear Agent001, Please recommend me the best Laptop under ₹70,000 for my son who is studying BE Electrical. Thank you.

–Bhushan Tyagi



Acer Nitro 5 (AN515-54)

A Hey Bhushan, The Acer Nitro 5 is a pretty good laptop considering that your son will have to make it last for four years. The processor is an Intel Core i5-9300H which is quite powerful and will easily be sufficient for the next four years. It even has a graphics card. The graphics card, while it can certainly be used for gaming, is also beneficial for certain software that your son might end up using during his 2nd, 3rd or final year. Most of the core Electrical Engineering software don't require graphics cards for acceleration but CAD (Computer Aided Design) software do use graphics cards for acceleration. It really depends on the syllabus and which projects your son takes up during his course.